



ENGLISH LANGUAGE

6873/02

Paper 2 Directed Writing and Composition

For examination from 2027-2029

SPECIMEN PAPER

Total marks: 50

Confidential

MARK SCHEME

QUESTION ANALYSIS AND EXPECTATIONS

EXERCISE 1: Informal Letter Writing

QUESTION

Your friend recently represented the country in an international sports competition and won a gold medal.

Write a letter to applaud your friend.

In your letter you should:

- **congratulate your friend on the victory**
- **ask about your friend's thoughts and feelings about the win**
- **encourage and wish them well for future success**

Your letter should be 1 page (**about 150 – 200 words**) long.

You will receive up to 7 marks for content for your letter and up to 7 marks for style and accuracy of your language.

EXPECTATIONS

The task is a **friendly/informal letter**.

The purpose is to applaud the friend for winning a gold medal in an international sports competition.

The audience is a friend; thus, the register is **informal/chatty**.

The tone is **friendly (casual)**.

The style/structure

Introduction

- ✓ portray social distance: casual opening, friendly tone, pleasantries e.g. asking about the friend's well-being, showing knowledge that the friend had taken part in a competition (may make mention of the name of this international competition here)
- ✓ the clue of the purpose, that is the reason they are writing the letter, is expected here

Body

- ✓ development of ideas to show or demonstrate independence of thought

The key word is '**applaud**' which creates an expectation of an excited and animated show of approval through choice of words.

- ✓ **The candidates ought to develop all given ideas(bullets):**
 - congratulate your friend on the victory – (a message of congratulations is expected here. If not already mentioned, the name of the competition won may also feature. Some candidates might compliment qualities that might have made the win possible.)
 - ask about your friend's thoughts and feelings about the win – (questions might include: whether they felt proud, elated, what their thoughts were when announced as winner or sometime after the win)
 - encourage and wish them well for future success – (words of encouragement, wisdom well wishes, and possibly some tips for future success)

Conclusion

- ✓ The conclusion should reconnect to the purpose of the letter.

Ending: e.g. Your loving friend

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Candidates are expected to show creativity, independence of thought in developing their ideas and use appropriate and sophisticated language.

Moreover, candidates should adhere to grammatical conventions and the letter should be 1 page long or about 150-200 words of standard handwriting.

EXERCISE 2: Formal Writing

QUESTION

There is an outcry over students who spend most of their time watching TV. Your school has suggested that parents limit the time students spend watching these as excessive watching affects their academic performance.

Write a formal article for your school magazine to warn fellow students about excessive watching of television.

In your article you should:

- explain the potential negative consequences of excessive watching of television
- suggest tips for students to manage their own viewing habits effectively
- emphasise the importance of balancing screen time with worthwhile activities.

Your article should be 1 page (**about 150-200 words**) long.

You will receive up to 7 marks for the content and up to 7 marks for style and accuracy of language.

EXPECTATIONS

The main issue here is **‘an outcry over students who spend most of their time watching TV’**

The task is **to write an article for a school magazine.**

The purpose is to **‘warn fellow students about excessive watching of television’.**

Candidates are expected to bring in fresh or novel ideas, paraphrase them (just use the given ideas as prompts and this demonstrates independence of thought)

The style/structure

Introduction

- ✓ The candidate is expected to write a compelling opening acknowledging the issue, give some background and state the purpose of the article.

Body

- ✓ The candidate is expected to develop the prompts given into a well-reasoned and well-written article explaining potential negative consequences of excessive television viewing, suggesting tips for managing viewing habits etc.

The candidate is expected to use a formal and informative tone, aiming to advise and warn, yet relatable to a student audience. It should avoid being overly casual, preachy, or condescending.

Conclusion

The candidate is expected to give an encouraging closing statement. They may summarise key warnings, a reiteration of the importance of balance etc.

The article should be paragraphed appropriately.

The candidate is expected to show creativity, independence of thought in developing the ideas and use appropriate and sophisticated language.

EXERCISE 3

Write about 350-450 words write on ONE of the following:

1. Write a story about a decision you made that makes you feel proud.
2. Describe an important social event you attended and the impact it had on your community.
3. Write an essay to explain some of the ways in which the youth can be empowered to become a better generation.

QUESTION 1: Narrative piece of writing

The candidates are expected to write a decision they made that makes them feel proud.

- ✓ The story should emanate from the given scenario.
- ✓ The candidate should narrate the events or situations they found themselves in that led to them having to make a grave decision.
- ✓ As the story unfolds, realistic details about what the decision was and how it yielded positive outcomes that they are proud of (why they are proud they made the decision) should be narrated.
- ✓ There should be a clear plot, suspense and great use of language in action.

The style/structure

- ✓ Introduction
- ✓ Body
- ✓ Conclusion

Candidates are expected to show creativity, independence of thought in developing the ideas and use appropriate and sophisticated language.

QUESTION 2: Descriptive piece of writing

Describe an important social event you attended and the impact it had on your community.

- ✓ The candidate is expected to show awareness that the question is in two folds.
- ✓ The candidate is expected to **describe** an important social event they attended and how it influenced their community

- ✓ The candidate is expected to give full details and paint a clear or vivid motion picture of this event for the reader. They should show how it was significant and the impact it had on their community e.g. a change in the community after this event (this may be positive or negative).
- ✓ The candidate is expected to use sensory details that appeal to the five senses: sight, hearing, smell, taste and touch.
- ✓ The candidate is expected to use descriptive language: strong verbs and powerful adjectives

The style/structure

- ✓ Introduction
- ✓ Body
- ✓ Conclusion

Question 3: Expository piece of writing

Write an essay some of the ways in which the youth can be empowered to become a better generation.

The key word here is ‘**how?**’.

- ✓ Candidates are expected to write an informative essay, suggesting ways or strategies on how the youth can be empowered (encouraged and equipped) to become a better generation.
- ✓ The candidate is expected to highlight different issues (financial, social, wellness issues, etc.) the youth is facing e.g. education and unemployment, social media, drug use, peer pressure, etc.
- ✓ They are also expected to then suggest ways on how the youth can be enabled to overcome these to become a better generation. Such may include strengthening and financing education, imparting leadership skills, mentoring, development of new technologies, encouraging apprenticeships, etc.
- ✓ Candidates might also support their suggestions and ideas with evidence.

The style/structure

- ✓ Introduction
- ✓ Body
- ✓ Conclusion

MARKING ANNOTATIONS

✓	Credit
—	spelling error / inappropriate word/ inappropriate use of word
^	omission
^^	double omission
≡	wrong tense
}}	light magnitude erratic paragraph or lines
	gross error of whole paragraph and no sense can be deciphered
()	unnecessary word, especially one that repeats the idea, for example 'the boys they'
BI	blatant Irrelevance
Rr	redundancy
MI	minor irrelevance

GENERAL CRITERIA FOR MARKING EXERCISES 1 AND 2

Mark Band	CONTENT: relevance and development of ideas (AO: R1, W1, W2, W4)	Mark Band	LANGUAGE: style and accuracy (AO: W1, W3, W5, W6)
7	Highly effective: • Relevance: Fulfills the task, with consistently appropriate register and excellent sense of purpose and audience. • Development of ideas: shows independence of thought. Ideas are very well developed, at appropriate length and persuasive. Quality is sustained throughout. Highly enjoyable to read. The interest of the reader is aroused and sustained.	7	Fluent: • Style: Almost first language competence. Ease of style. Sophisticated, confident and wide ranging use of language, idioms and tenses. • Accuracy: No or very few errors. Perfectly constructed and linked paragraphs.
5 - 6	Effective: • Relevance: Fulfills the task, with appropriate register and good sense of purpose and audience. • Development of ideas: Ideas are well developed and at appropriate length. Engages reader's interest.	5 - 6	Precise: • Style: Sentences show variety of structure and length. Uses some idioms and is precise in use of vocabulary. However, there may be some awkwardness in style making reading less enjoyable. • Accuracy: Generally accurate, apart from occasional frustrating minor errors. There are paragraphs showing some unity, although links maybe absent or inappropriate.
3 - 4	Satisfactory: • Relevance: Generally fulfills the task, with reasonable attempt at appropriate register, and some sense of purpose and audience. A satisfactory attempt has been made to address the topic, but there may be digressions. • Development of ideas: Material is satisfactorily developed at appropriate length.	3 - 4	Safe: • Style: Mainly simple structures and vocabulary, sometimes attempting more sophisticated language. • Accuracy: Meaning is clear, and work is of a safe, literate standard. Simple structures are generally sound, apart from infrequent spelling errors, which do not interfere with communication. Grammatical errors occur when more sophistication is attempted. Paragraphs are used but without coherence or unity.
1 - 2	Partly relevant: • Relevance: Partly relevant and some engagement with the task. Does not quite fulfil the task, although there are some positive qualities. Inappropriate register, showing insufficient awareness of purpose and/or audience. • Development of ideas: Supplies some detail and explanation, but the effect is incomplete. Some repetition. • Limited engagement with the task, but this is mostly hidden by density of error. Award 1 mark.	1 - 2	Errors intrude: • Style: Simple structures and vocabulary. • Accuracy: Meaning is sometimes in doubt. Frequent, distracting errors hamper precision and slow down reading. However, these do not seriously impair communication. Paragraphs absent or inconsistent. • Multiple types of errors in grammar/spelling/word usage/punctuation throughout, which mostly make it difficult to understand. • Occasionally, sense can be deciphered. Paragraphs absent or haphazard. Award 1 mark.
0	Little relevance: • No engagement with the task or any engagement with task is completely hidden by density of error. If essay is completely irrelevant, no mark can be given for language.	0	Hard to understand: • Density of error completely obscures meaning. Whole sections impossible to recognise as pieces of English writing. Paragraphs absent or inconsistent.

GENERAL CRITERIA FOR MARKING EXERCISE 3

MARK Band	CONTENT: relevance and development of ideas (AO: W1, W2, W4)	MARK Band	LANGUAGE: style and accuracy (AO: W1, W3, W5, W6)
11	Highly effective: Relevance: Consistently relevant, uses appropriate register and excellent sense of purpose and audience. Development of ideas: shows independence of thought. Ideas are well developed, at appropriate length. The interest of the reader is highly aroused and sustained. Quality is sustained throughout and enjoyable to read.	11	Fluent : Style: Almost first language competence. Sentence structure varied for particular effects. Confident and wide-ranging use of language and idioms. Vocabulary is wide and precise to convey intended shades of meaning. Accuracy: Highly accurate apart from very occasional slips. Paragraphs have unity, are linked and show evidence of being well-organised.
9 - 10	Effective: Relevance: Fulfils the task with consistently appropriate register and a sense of purpose and audience. Development of ideas: Shows independence of thought. Ideas are well developed, at appropriate length. The interest of the reader is aroused and sustained. Quality is sustained. Enjoyable to read.	9 - 10	Precise Style: Generally accurate apart from occasional errors that are either slips or caused by ambition. Uses some idioms and precise in use of vocabulary to convey intended shades of meaning Accuracy: Paragraphs have unity, are usually linked and show some evidence of being well-organized.
7 - 8	Upper satisfactory: Relevance: Fulfils the task, with appropriate register and good sense of purpose and audience. Development of ideas: Some interest is aroused.	7 - 8	Mostly accurate: Style: Some variety of sentence structures and vocabulary, sometimes attempting sophisticated language. Accuracy: Mostly accurate, errors from ambition do not mar clarity of communication. There are paragraphs showing some unity, although links may be absent or inappropriate.
5 - 6	Lower satisfactory: Relevance: Fulfils the task, with reasonable attempt at appropriate register, and some sense of purpose and audience. A satisfactory attempt has been made to address the topic, but there may be digressions or failures of logic. Development of ideas: Material is satisfactorily developed at appropriate length.	5 - 6	Safe: Style: Mainly simple structures and vocabulary. Accuracy: Meaning is clear, and work is of a safe literate standard. Simple structures are generally sound, apart from infrequent spelling errors, which do not interfere with communication. Spelling of simple vocabulary is accurate, errors in more difficult words. Paragraphs are used but without coherence or unity.
3 - 4	Partly relevant: Relevance: Partly relevant and some engagement with the task, although there are some positive qualities. Inappropriate register, showing insufficient awareness of purpose and/ or audience. Development of ideas: Supplies some detail and explanation, but the effect is incomplete. Some repetition.	3 - 4	Errors intrude: Style: Simple structure and vocabulary. Accuracy: Meaning is sometimes in doubt. Frequent, distracting errors hamper precision and slow down reading. However, these do not seriously impair communicating.
1 - 2	Little relevance: Limited engagement with the task or any engagement with task is completely hidden by density of errors.	1 - 2	Multiple errors: Multiple types of error in grammar/spelling/word usage/punctuation throughout which mostly make it difficult to understand. Occasionally, sense can be deciphered.
0	No relevance: No engagement with the task. If essay is completely irrelevant, no mark can be given for language.	0	Hard to understand: Density of errors. Whole sections impossible to recognise as pieces of English writing.

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